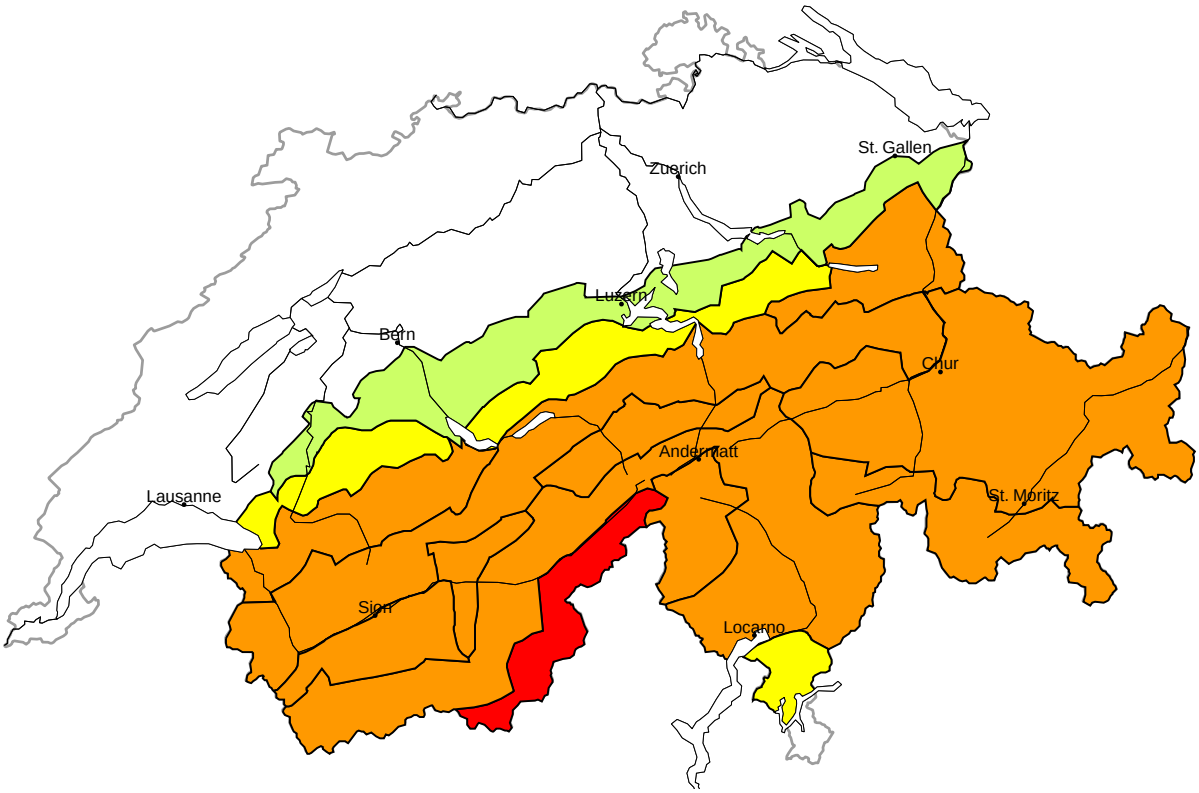
Avalanche danger

updated on 12.4.2026, 17:00

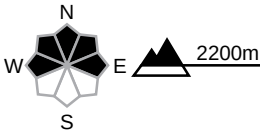


region A

High (4-)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description

Large quantities of fresh snow and the wind-drifted snow are prone to triggering. Dry avalanches can be triggered in the old snowpack. Natural avalanches are to be expected from the second half of the night, even very large ones in isolated cases. They can release the wet old snow as well and can reach as far as the valley bottom. Exposed parts of transportation routes can be endangered in some cases. The snow sport conditions outside marked and open pistes are very dangerous.

High (4)

Wet snow

As a consequence of the heavy rain a large number of wet avalanches are to be expected, in particular on steep west, north and east facing slopes below approximately 2200 m. Wet avalanches can in some cases release the entire snowpack and reach large size.

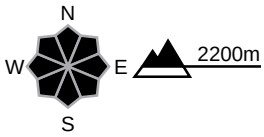
Danger levels 1 low 2 moderate 3 considerable 4 high 5 very high

region B

Considerable (3+)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs are prone to triggering at elevated altitudes. An increasing number of natural dry avalanches are possible. Dry avalanches can in some cases be triggered in the old snowpack and reach large size. They can release the wet old snow as well and can reach as far as areas without any snow cover.

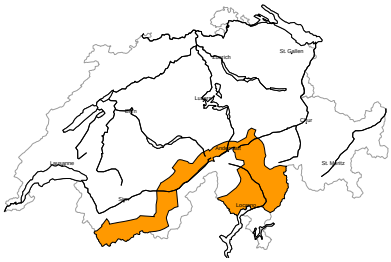
Considerable (3)

Wet snow

As a consequence of the rain numerous wet avalanches are to be expected, in particular on steep west, north and east facing slopes below approximately 2200 m. Wet avalanches can in some cases release the entire snowpack and reach large size. The conditions are very critical for backcountry touring.

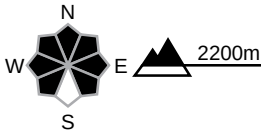
region C

Considerable (3=)



New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



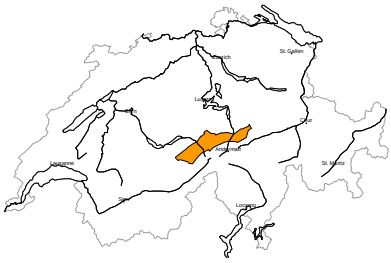
Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs are prone to triggering at elevated altitudes. Dry avalanches can also be triggered in the old snowpack and reach large size. Individual natural avalanches are possible as the day progresses. Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for experience in the assessment of avalanche danger and caution.

Considerable (3)

Wet snow

As a consequence of the rain numerous wet avalanches are to be expected, in particular on steep west, north and east facing slopes below approximately 2200 m. Wet avalanches can in some cases release the entire snowpack and reach large size. The conditions are very critical for backcountry touring.

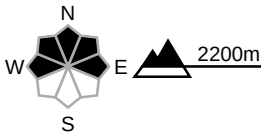
region D



Considerable (3-)

Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



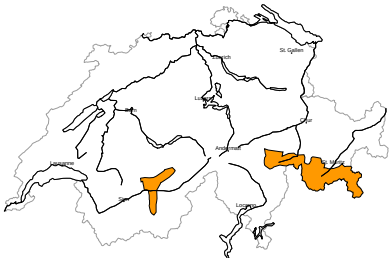
Danger description
As a consequence of new snow and southerly wind, avalanche prone wind slabs will form. Single winter sport participants can release avalanches. In some places dry avalanches can also be released in the old snowpack and reach large size in isolated cases. Backcountry touring calls for experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

Considerable (3)

Wet snow

The surface of the snowpack will freeze very little and will soften quickly. Wet and gliding avalanches are to be expected. This applies in particular on steep east, south and west facing slopes between approximately 2000 and 2800 m, as well as on steep north facing slopes below approximately 2400 m. Wet avalanches can additionally in some places be released by people. Avalanches can reach large size.
The conditions are critical for backcountry touring.

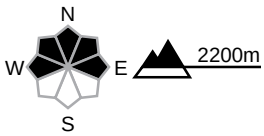
region E



Considerable (3-)

Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
As a consequence of new snow and southerly wind, avalanche prone wind slabs will form. Single winter sport participants can release avalanches. In some places dry avalanches can also be released in the old snowpack and reach large size in isolated cases. Backcountry touring calls for experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

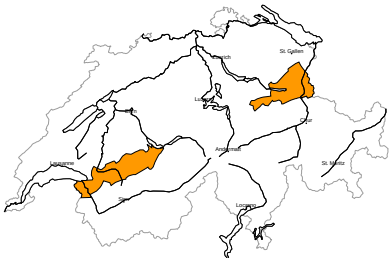
Considerable (3)

Wet snow

As a consequence of the rain numerous wet avalanches are to be expected, in particular on steep west, north and east facing slopes below approximately 2200 m. Wet avalanches can in some cases release the entire snowpack and reach large size. The conditions are very critical for backcountry touring.

region F

Considerable (3)



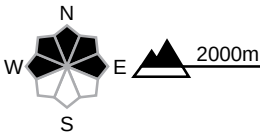
Wet snow

The surface of the snowpack will freeze very little and will soften quickly. Wet and gliding avalanches are to be expected. This applies in particular on steep east, south and west facing slopes between approximately 2000 and 2800 m, as well as on steep north facing slopes below approximately 2400 m. Wet avalanches can additionally in some places be released by people. Avalanches can reach large size.
The conditions are critical for backcountry touring.

Low (1)

No distinct avalanche problem

Avalanche prone locations

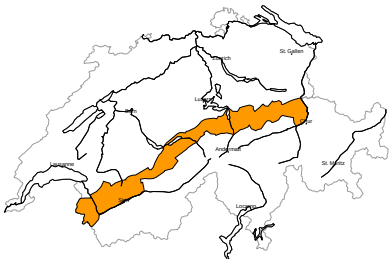


Danger description

Dry avalanches are unlikely to occcur. Very isolated avalanche prone locations are to be found in particular on extremely steep shady slopes at elevated altitudes.

region G

Considerable (3)



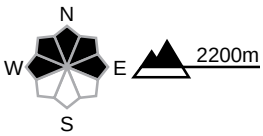
Wet snow

The surface of the snowpack will freeze very little and will soften quickly. Wet and gliding avalanches are to be expected. This applies in particular on steep east, south and west facing slopes between approximately 2000 and 2800 m, as well as on steep north facing slopes below approximately 2400 m. Wet avalanches can additionally in some places be released by people. Avalanches can reach large size.
The conditions are critical for backcountry touring.

Moderate (2=)

Wind slab

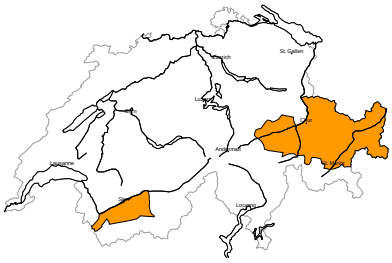
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description

As a consequence of new snow and southerly wind, sometimes avalanche prone wind slabs will form at elevated altitudes. These are to be found in particular adjacent to ridgelines and in gullies and bowls. The avalanches can in some places be released by a single winter sport participant and reach medium size. Careful route selection is recommended.

region H



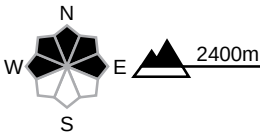
Considerable (3)

Wet snow
The surface of the snowpack will freeze very little. Wet avalanches are possible from the late morning. This applies in particular on steep sunny slopes between approximately 2000 and 3000 m, as well as on steep north facing slopes below approximately 2400 m. Wet avalanches can be released by people. Isolated whumpfing sounds can indicate the danger. Avalanches can reach large size.
The backcountry touring conditions are critical.

Moderate (2=)

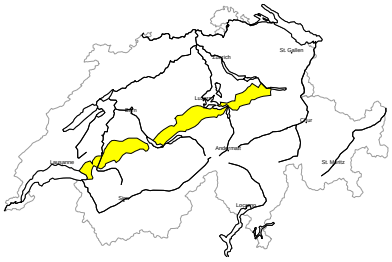
Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
In some places dry avalanches can be released in the old snowpack and reach large size in isolated cases. These avalanche prone locations are barely recognisable, even to the trained eye. Caution is to be exercised in areas where the snow cover is rather shallow in little used backcountry terrain.
As a consequence of southerly wind, rather small wind slabs will form in some localities.
Careful route selection is recommended.

region I



Moderate (2)

Wet snow
Wet and gliding avalanches are possible, even medium-sized ones. The avalanche prone locations are to be found in particular on west, north and east facing slopes. Careful route selection is important.

Low (1)

No distinct avalanche problem

Avalanche prone locations

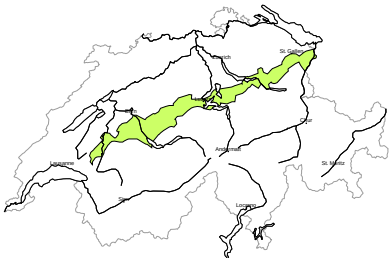
Danger description
Dry avalanches are unlikely to occcur. Very isolated avalanche prone locations are to be found in particular on extremely steep shady slopes at elevated altitudes.

region J

Moderate (2)

Wet snow
As a consequence of the rain wet avalanches are possible, in particular on steep west, north and east facing slopes. Avalanches can reach medium size in isolated cases. Even a small avalanche can sweep people along and give rise to falls.

region K — Low (1)



Wet snow

On steep grassy slopes individual wet snow slides are possible. Restraint should be exercised because avalanches can sweep people along and give rise to falls.

Snowpack and weather

updated on 12.4.2026, 17:00

Snowpack

With the mild weather, partly overcast nights and occasional rain, moistening of the snowpack continued over the course of last week. On south-facing slopes the snowpack is water-saturated up to around 3000 m, and on east- and west-facing slopes up to 2500 to 2700 m, while on north-facing slopes it is water-saturated below 2000 m, with moistening progressing between 2000 and 2400 m.
Given the expected volumes of fresh snow, heavy at times in the south, large snowdrift accumulations will form at high altitudes. On north-facing slopes in particular, naturally triggered avalanches may sweep away the entire snowpack, especially in regions exposed to heavier precipitation in Valais, but occasionally also in other regions. In addition, avalanches in the fresh and drifted snow may be triggered by human activity.
With the rain, more wet and gliding avalanches are also to be expected.

Weather review for Sunday

Conditions were mostly cloudy, with light showers in the Prealps. The snowfall level was around 2000 m. There were brighter intervals in Grisons.

Fresh snow
-

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, around +3 °C in the north and in Ticino and +6 °C in the inneralpine regions

Wind
Light to moderate southerly, increasing to moderate to strong on the northern Alpine ridge during the course of the day

Weather forecast to Monday

On Sunday evening precipitation will set in in the south, becoming heavier overnight to Monday, with some regions of the south seeing very heavy precipitation. The precipitation will also spread to northern regions, but will be lighter there. The snowfall level will be around 1800 to 2000 m, falling to 1500 to 1700 m by Monday morning in the regions exposed to heavier precipitation on the main Alpine ridge in Upper Valais.

Fresh snow
By Monday afternoon above 2200 to 2400 m:
- Monte Rosa region, Saas Valley, Simplon region: 60 to 80 cm
- rest of main Alpine ridge in upper Valais, northwest Ticino: 40 to 60 cm
- rest of main Alpine ridge from the Great St. Bernard Pass to the Lukmanier Pass, northern Alpine ridge from the Lötschental to the Reuss, lower Valle Maggia, Valle Leventina: 20 to 40 cm
- rest of Valais, rest of northern Alpine ridge west of Tödi, main Alpine ridge from the Lukmanier Pass to the Bernina region: 15 to 30 cm
- elsewhere a few centimetres or dry

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, around +2 °C in the west and south and +4 °C in the east

Wind
Strong south to southeasterly overnight to Monday in the high Alpine regions, elsewhere moderate to strong, dying down in the afternoon

Outlook

Tuesday
Conditions will be very cloudy with light precipitation. The snowfall level will be around 1500 to 1800 m in the north and 1800 to 2000 m in the south. As the day progresses it will brighten up, especially in Valais and in the south. There will be a light to moderate northeasterly wind.
The danger of dry avalanches will decrease in the south. However, off-piste skiing conditions will remain critical at high altitudes. In the north, there will be hardly any change in dry avalanche danger. Wet avalanches are possible in all regions, especially on west-, north- and east-facing slopes below approximately 2400 m. In the regions with fresh snow, loose snow avalanches are to be expected in the fresh snow at high altitudes with the warmth from the sun, and also moist snow slides and glide snow avalanches at intermediate altitudes.

Wednesday
Conditions will be quite sunny, with a possibility of isolated light showers over the course of the day. The zero-degree level will rise to 2800 m. Winds will mostly be light. The danger of dry avalanches will decrease. The danger of wet avalanches will increase during the day.